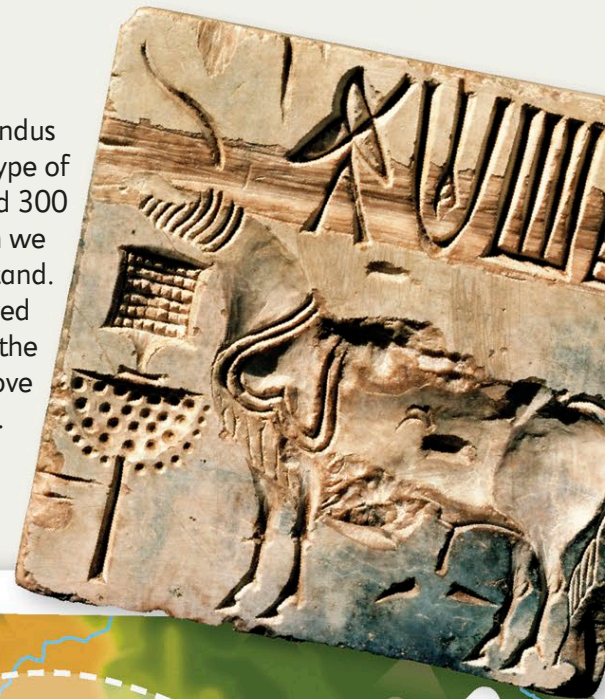


Indus Valley

The land around the Indus River was the birthplace of another of the first civilizations. Beginning around 2600 BCE, people here built carefully planned cities. This was the largest early civilization, bigger than Egypt and Mesopotamia put together. There is no evidence left of how the people of the Indus Valley were ruled.

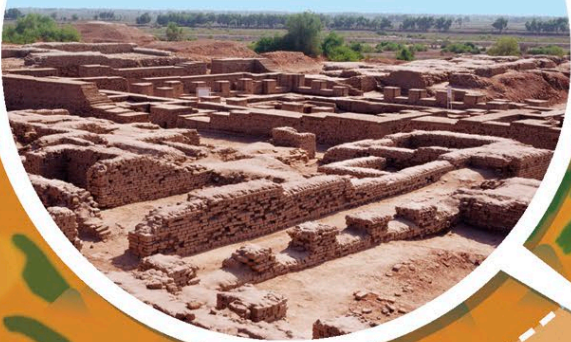
Indus seal

The people of the Indus Valley invented a type of writing with around 300 picture signs, which we still cannot understand. It was used on carved stone seals, where the signs appeared above pictures of animals.



Ruins of Mohenjo-Daro

The biggest Indus city was Mohenjo-Daro. Every house had its own water supply, toilet, and bath.



KEY (2600 BCE)

Goods coming into the Indus area



Silver

This metal was used to make jewelry.



Copper

This metal was used to make pots and knives.



Lapis lazuli

This blue stone from Afghanistan was used to make jewelry.



Tin

This metal was mixed with copper to make bronze.



Cotton growing

Cotton fibers were woven into cloth.

Carnelian

A red stone called carnelian was used to make beads for jewelry.

Asian elephant

Elephants were hunted for their ivory tusks.

Lothal

Pearls

Coastal people collected oysters to get the pearls sometimes found inside.

ARABIAN SEA

Indus traders traveled by boat, taking goods along the rivers.

THAR DESERT



SCALE

0 100 miles
0 100 kilometers

River network

The Indus civilization grew up around small rivers that flowed into the large Indus River, which ended at the Arabian Sea.

